

PRAISEL EKPENYONG

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity student with hands-on SOC experience through dual-stack home labs (Splunk/Wazuh and Microsoft Sentinel). CompTIA Security+ and SC-200 certified with practical skills in alert triage, SIEM operations, incident investigation, detection rule development, and SOAR automation. Built and documented end-to-end security investigations mapped to MITRE ATT&CK. Experienced in proactive monitoring, phishing analysis, and writing detection rules that evolve with emerging threats.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **SIEM & Detection:** Splunk (SPL), Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), Wazuh, alert triage and correlation, log analysis
- **Incident Response:** End-to-end incident investigation, containment and eradication, evidence preservation, NIST IR lifecycle, incident documentation and reporting
- **SOAR & Automation:** Shuffle, TheHive, API integration (VirusTotal, AbuseIPDB), Python automation
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST CSF, Cyber Kill Chain, IOC extraction and enrichment
- **Infrastructure:** Sysmon, Windows Event Logs, Active Directory, TCP/IP, DNS, Wireshark, firewall configuration, Azure cloud security

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701)
- Microsoft Certified: Security Operations Analyst Associate (SC-200)
- Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate
- HackTheBox Academy — SOC Analyst Path (incident handling, detection engineering, SIEM operations)
- TryHackMe — SOC Level 1 Path (alert triage, SOC workflows, investigation procedures)

SECURITY PROJECTS

SOC Analyst Home Lab

Splunk, Wazuh, Sysmon, Active Directory, osTicket, Atomic Red Team

- Built a virtualized SOC environment and developed 6 custom Splunk detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK including brute force (T1110), PowerShell abuse (T1059.001), and lateral movement (T1021)
- Conducted 5 end-to-end security investigations with documented timelines, SIEM queries, IOCs, and response recommendations — demonstrating the triage-to-resolution workflow expected in a SOC
- Created incident response playbooks for phishing, brute force, and malware scenarios and integrated osTicket for incident lifecycle management
- Performed phishing email analysis including header inspection, spoofing indicator identification, and classification of credential harvesting and BEC attempts

AI-Augmented SOC Automation

Shuffle SOAR, TheHive, Python, VirusTotal API, AbuseIPDB API

- Designed 3 automated SOAR workflows: Mimikatz detection with auto-enrichment, brute force response with conditional IP blocking, and phishing auto-triage — reducing manual triage time from 15+ minutes to under 60 seconds
- Developed Python automation scripts for IOC extraction, hash reputation lookups, log parsing with brute force detection, and multi-source alert enrichment with risk scoring
- Built conditional response logic: high-confidence threats trigger auto-containment via Wazuh active response, low-confidence alerts route to analyst for manual investigation
- Created AI triage validation framework tracking precision, recall, and false negative rates to audit automated triage decisions and identify detection gaps

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Cybersecurity

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Sales Director | *Hava Medicals*

Healthcare Equipment & Supplies | 2 years

- Directed stakeholder communications and managed multiple client accounts, building the written/verbal communication skills critical for SOC incident reporting and cross-team coordination
- Analyzed procurement data to identify trends and optimize decisions, developing the pattern recognition and analytical mindset applicable to security log analysis
- Created and maintained procedural documentation and client requirement records, directly transferable to SOC playbook development and incident documentation